

Swiss AI Sovereignty Strategy

Day 7B: Capabilities, Alignment, and Techno-Bloc Dependence

Scenario. Switzerland has strong research institutions, specialized industries, capital, and trusted governance, but no domestic frontier-model champion and limited hyperscale cloud capacity. It depends on foreign chips, cloud providers, and frontier models while facing energy, land, and data-protection constraints.

Step 1: Dependency Map

Rank Switzerland's three most consequential dependencies.

Capability	Severity	Why the dependency matters
Advanced chips		
Cloud and compute		
Frontier models		
Energy and grid capacity		
Data and sectoral access		
Research and talent		
Evaluation and security capacity		

Step 2: Choose a Strategic Orientation

- **AI mercantilism:** build and protect domestic capabilities.
- **Alignment:** secure privileged access through a preferred techno-bloc.
- **Regulatory sovereignty:** shape access through standards, procurement, and legal control.
- **Hybrid:** combine selective domestic capacity with alignment and regulation.

Policy Budget

You have **10 points**. Select no more than four instruments.

Instrument	Cost	Purpose
National sovereign-compute facility	5	reserved capacity for research and public-interest uses
Secure public-sector cloud layer	3	protect sensitive services without full autarky
Open-weight model and application ecosystem	2	reduce dependence at the application layer
National evaluation and model-security authority	2	trusted testing, certification, and bargaining power
Strategic public procurement	2	create demand and interoperability requirements
Compute and chip alliance with preferred partners	3	priority access and crisis guarantees
Data-space and localization requirements	2	control sensitive sectoral data
Talent, research, and commercialization package	2	strengthen domestic complementary assets
Energy and grid package for compute	3	expand reliable low-carbon capacity

Step 3: Test the Sovereignty Claim

Explain whether the strategy:

- reduces dependence;
- diversifies dependence;
- transfers dependence to a preferred partner; or
- creates bargaining leverage without technological independence.

Step 4: Identify Switzerland's Bargaining Asset

What can Switzerland offer firms and partner states in exchange for privileged access: capital, research, secure infrastructure, trusted regulation, specialized industries, diplomacy, or standards leadership?

Required Output

Deliver a four-minute cabinet briefing containing the dependency map, selected instruments, preferred alignment, and one scenario in which the strategy fails.